

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption Leader, Workforce Transformation, Hands-On Builder

Three-time Values Champion for TIAA Client Services (2022, 2025, 2026) and a Fall 2025 Face of TIAA

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Adoption is personal before it is organizational. Someone adopts AI when they rethink how their own work could be done, not when they are handed a license. I measure whether that happened by active usage, not headcount with access. At TIAA I reported the 1,500+ associates I reached directly while 16,000+ had access, because the second number flatters and the first one is true. I was there fifteen years, in a business where Risk, Compliance, and Legal could stop anything I built. Earlier, ten years at Pearson and Vangent serving Fortune 500 enterprises and federal agencies. My M.S. in Instructional Technology is in how people learn and decide, and how to design the experience that gets them there.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA (Fortune 100 Financial Services, \$1.5T AUM)

Business Manager (2016-2022) | Sr. Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Led enterprise initiatives across the Client Services organization (~3,000 associates). Led the associate-transformation workstream of TIAA's Recordkeeping Transformation program. Partnered across HR, Workplace Services, Facilities, Risk and Compliance, and IT.

AI Adoption, Governance, and Capability Design

- **CareerSpark, AI-Powered Career Development Platform (2024-2025):** Conceived, designed, and launched a 9-module AI-powered capability platform, rolled out enterprise-wide. Full lifecycle ownership from discovery through governance, deployment, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 30+ town halls and events I ran myself.
- **Responsible AI Governance:** Scoped the platform with business stakeholders, then partnered with Risk, Compliance, and Legal to define what it could and could not do. No client data or PII entered into the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the person in control of every decision.
- **AI-Generated Video in Production:** Built a named product persona in Synthesia and shipped four videos inside CareerSpark, including the first thing an associate saw when they opened the platform. I made the presenter fictional rather than a synthetic double of a real executive.
- **Skills of the Future Curriculum (2024):** Led a team of 7 to design 5 asynchronous, self-paced curriculum tracks (12-17 modules each) on future and digital-first skills. 890 associates accessed the training.
- **AI-Assisted Solution Development:** Built the CareerSpark Manager Guide on Amazon Q Developer in one week. The platform itself had taken months with generative AI before agentic tooling existed, so the comparison is to my own work rather than an industry estimate.

Operating Frameworks and Enterprise Modernization

- **Multi-Unit Operating Framework:** Connected seven Client Services business areas through liaisons, peer learning, and shared strategy across Workplace, Associate Engagement, and Rewards and Recognition.
- **Workplace Modernization at Scale (2022-2024):** Led change strategy across six locations through return-to-office, the Denver consolidation (44% footprint reduction, 700+ to hoteling), and the Frisco Corporate Center opening for 500+, where I was recognized as Change Champion.
- **Recognition Program (2014-2025):** Built and negotiated a \$300K annual engagement budget with Finance, and grew Client Services into the source of 34% of all recognitions company-wide in 2021, more than the next five organizations combined. Earned a seat on the corporate platform selection team.

Cross-Functional Delivery

- **Virtual Career Fair (2020):** Custom-coded a virtual event platform when COVID ended in-person gatherings. Open to the full Client Services population, with 800+ attending live. Three other teams reused the code to build their own, and I transformed it into the TIAA Product Expo.
- **Systems and Data Governance (2011-2021):** Designed the Management Systems suite, the operational dashboards leaders used to run their areas. Owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 PII-flagged files with IT.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital

Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions, serving Fortune 500 enterprises and federal agencies.

- **Enterprise Client Consulting:** Worked directly with Fortune 500 clients (Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, Regions Bank) to scope capability needs, design adoption approaches, and shape multi-year implementation plans across business, technology, and end-user audiences.
- **Technical Solutions & Field Enablement:** Surfaced field-driven ATS enhancements that shipped into the product, working across enterprise LCMS and ATS platforms as knowledge engineer and information architect.
- **Federal & Enterprise Delivery:** Sales engineer on the team that won enterprise ATS deals with the U.S. Department of Commerce (2010 Census) and Extra Space Storage. Deployed Revolver LCMS across 5 Fortune 500 enterprises, designing knowledge architecture that separated core content from contextual delivery.

INDEPENDENT AI WORK

- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com):** Live AI career-discovery platform on Next.js, the Vercel AI SDK, and multi-provider AI. I conceived it, designed the 5-stage framework, and structured the 922-occupation O*NET dataset behind it.
- **CareerPointers (careerpointers.org):** Live 11-module career platform on Next.js, TypeScript, and Stripe with employer-personalized delivery and an applicant CRM. I conceived it and directed the build. Its agentic 4-agent Claude interview simulator, TheHotSeat, generates role-specific questions and returns scored coaching reports. Mike Pointer is co-founder on both and engineered the production backends, the databases and security that made them real.
- **The Expert Project Team Method:** I run a standing team of AI agents every day. Each agent has a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose only job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI & Transformation: AI Adoption Strategy | Responsible AI Governance | AI Literacy & Enablement | Agentic AI & Multi-Agent Workflows | Hands-on Builder across ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, Kiro, GitHub Copilot, M365 Copilot

Strategy & Modernization: Operating Framework Design | Modernization Strategy | Organizational Readiness | Business Case Development | Risk & Compliance Partnership

Enterprise Delivery: Cross-Functional Influence (HR, Tech, Business, Risk, Legal) | Executive Read-Outs & Decision Forums | Stakeholder Management | Budget Management (roughly \$500K in Client Services program spend administered) | Change Management

Learning & Capability Design: Instructional Design (M.S.) | Curriculum & Capability Strategy | Adoption Measurement | Lean for Financial Services

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Master of Science, Instructional Technology - Bloomsburg University of Pennsylvania (4.0 GPA)

Bachelor of Arts, Art (Commercial Art) - Millersville University of Pennsylvania

Certifications: Generative AI Leader Certification, Google (2026) | Leadership Skills, The Institute for Management Studies (2025) | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class)

Awards: Three-time Values Champion (2022, 2025, 2026), the annual Client Services award for top performers of the year | Face of TIAA (Fall 2025), selected company-wide, one of four that month | Change Champion (2025)

Appointments: Denver Leadership Council